

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Insurance English



Learner workbook

Work with realistic cases, develop your own response, and use the answer section after you have tried the tasks.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For underwriters, claims adjusters, brokers, risk managers, actuarial analysts, policy-service teams, compliance staff, and insurance operations leaders.

Fictional language practice. Legal, financial, and regulatory meanings depend on jurisdiction and context; use current documents and qualified review for actual decisions.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Your course at a glance

Use the lesson numbers to match this document with the website and the other guides.

01 Underwriting and Risk Selection

Clarify missing information before responding.

02 Policy Language and Coverage Interpretation

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

03 Claims Intake and Reserving

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

04 Coverage Disputes and Denials

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

05 Broker and Client Renewal Meetings

Compare options using the same criteria and state the tradeoff.

06 Fraud Indicators and SIU Referral

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

07 Actuarial Assumptions and Pricing

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

08 Compliance, Market Conduct, and Complaints

Acknowledge a communication problem and give a corrected message.

Choose your pace

Quick practice: spend 15 minutes reading one conversation and rehearsing one scenario. Full lesson: allow 45-60 minutes for language work, three conversations, two speaking scenarios, and feedback.

Level support

B1 learners can use the frames and a partner. B2 learners can try a response before reading the model. C1 learners can add the harder follow-up and reduce preparation time. These are teaching suggestions, not certified CEFR level ratings.

After practicing: open the AI prompt workshop to choose a vocabulary, grammar, role-play, or new-dialogue activity.

LESSON 01 / READ AND NOTICE

Underwriting and Risk Selection

Clarify missing information before responding.

SITUATION

An underwriting submission describes a business activity broadly but omits its operating locations and loss history.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

underwriting - Evaluation of risk and terms used to decide whether and on what conditions to issue insurance, extend credit, or accept an investment exposure.

risk appetite - The amount and types of risk an organization is prepared to pursue or retain.

exposure - The extent to which people, assets, or operations are subject to a hazard or potential loss.

loss history - A record of prior claims or losses for an insured risk.

3. Notice the language

Name the exact word, fact, or requirement you need clarified. Ask one focused question at a time. Repeat your understanding and give the other person a chance to correct it.

When you say ..., do you mean ...?

Could you clarify which ...?

So, my understanding is Is that right?

Compare this wording: Could you explain what does this mean?

LESSON 01 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Ask a precise question

4. Check the language

1. Which indirect question has the usual word order?
 - A. Could you confirm when the review starts?
 - B. Could you confirm when does the review start?
 - C. Could you confirm when starts the review?
2. Someone says the report is 'ready.' Which question best clarifies its approval status?
 - A. Can you send the report to me this afternoon?
 - B. Who will present the report at the meeting?
 - C. Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review?

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Which operations and locations are included?

Fictional underwriting intake: a submission says business services but omits operating locations and loss history. No coverage or acceptance decision is made.

01 • Underwriting assistant: The submission says business services. Could you clarify the activities and operating locations included?

02 • Broker account manager: The description is broad, and I haven't obtained the location schedule or loss history yet.

03 • Underwriting assistant: Those gaps affect the exposure information available for review. Who can provide the verified details?

04 • Broker account manager: I'll ask the client's authorized contact rather than assume all work happens at the registered address.

05 • Underwriting assistant: Thank you. Please distinguish current operations from any planned activities when obtaining the description.

06 • Broker account manager: Does requesting those details mean the risk already fits your underwriting appetite?

07 • Underwriting assistant: No. An information request isn't acceptance, a quote, or a coverage decision.

08 • Broker account manager: I'll keep that clear with the client and ask what loss-history records are available.

09 • Underwriting assistant: If any period is missing, identify it explicitly instead of describing the history as claim-free.

10 • Broker account manager: I'll return the verified activity and location details with any remaining gaps clearly marked for review.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Storage or manufacturing?

Separate fictional submission: a facility is described as a warehouse, but an attachment mentions assembly work; the extent of that activity is unspecified.

01 • Commercial underwriter: The form says warehouse, while the attachment mentions assembly. What activity actually occurs at the facility?

02 • Broker placement specialist: I need to clarify that with the client. The attachment doesn't describe the assembly process.

03 • Commercial underwriter: Please ask whether it's a current operation and which location the description concerns.

04 • Broker placement specialist: Would calling it minor assembly be enough to keep the exposure summary brief?

05 • Commercial underwriter: Not unless the client supplies facts supporting that description. Minor is too vague by itself.

06 • Broker placement specialist: I'll request a factual activity description and avoid choosing a label based on expected risk appetite.

07 • Commercial underwriter: Good. We need accurate information before considering how the submission fits our review criteria.

08 • Broker placement specialist: Should I tell the client that clarifying the activity guarantees a more favorable underwriting outcome?

09 • Commercial underwriter: No outcome is guaranteed. The purpose is a complete, accurate submission for assessment.

10 • Broker placement specialist: I'll explain that distinction and return with confirmed operations rather than an unsupported risk characterization.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A blank loss field is not a clean history

Separate fictional renewal submission: the loss-history field is blank; the broker has not established whether records are unavailable or no losses were reported.

01 • Underwriting coordinator: The loss-history field is blank. Does that mean no reported losses, or information not yet supplied?

02 • Broker service lead: We haven't established which. The client returned the form without completing that section.

03 • Underwriting coordinator: Please clarify the status and the period covered before we use it in the underwriting review.

04 • Broker service lead: Could I enter none temporarily so the application moves through the intake screen?

05 • Underwriting coordinator: No. That would turn missing information into a factual claim about the client's loss history.

06 • Broker service lead: I'll request the relevant records and identify any period the client cannot currently document.

07 • Underwriting coordinator: Thank you. Also avoid assuming a blank field establishes low exposure or automatic eligibility.

08 • Broker service lead: Understood. Is the immediate goal clarification, rather than asking the client to predict our decision?

09 • Underwriting coordinator: Exactly. We need evidence and an accurate status, not assurances about the eventual underwriting outcome.

10 • Broker service lead: I'll return a verified answer or explicitly state what remains missing for the review.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Underwriting and Risk Selection

An underwriting submission describes a business activity broadly but omits its operating locations and loss history.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

Second round: The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Model for scenario 1: Could you confirm the activities, locations, and requested loss-history information? Those details will help the underwriting team assess the submission without relying on assumptions about the business.

Scenario 2 | Is the third site operating or planned?

A fictional submission lists three operating sites, but a separate note calls one site planned for next year. Its current operating status is unverified. Clarify the location schedule before underwriting review.

Role A: Underwriting analyst: ask whether the third site is current or proposed.

Role B: Broker coordinator: agree to obtain the client's verified status without removing the site on assumption.

Possible opening: Could you clarify whether the third location is operating now or is only planned?

Success checks

- Distinguish current operations from plans.
- Preserve the unresolved site information.
- Avoid promising an underwriting outcome.

Add a complication: The broker asks whether excluding it would guarantee acceptance.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 02 / READ AND NOTICE

Policy Language and Coverage Interpretation

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

SITUATION

A client sees a policy summary and assumes it includes every term of coverage. The full policy has endorsements and exclusions.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

policy - The insurance contract setting out coverage, exclusions, conditions, and limits.

endorsement - A document that changes an insurance policy's terms.

exclusion - Something outside an agreed scope or expressly not covered by a policy or agreement.

coverage - The protection provided by an insurance policy; in telecommunications, the area with service availability.

3. Notice the language

Start with the reader's question. Explain one unfamiliar term with familiar words, then give a relevant example or contrast. Check understanding without asking only 'Do you understand?'.

In this context, ... means

The difference is that

How would you explain that distinction to a colleague?

Compare this wording: We need to operationalize the implementation.

LESSON 02 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Make a complex point clear

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence explains 'backlog' rather than repeating it?
 - A. The backlog is the work completed during the last period.
 - B. The backlog is the maximum work the team can finish in a period.
 - C. The backlog is the work still waiting to be completed.
2. Which follow-up best checks whether your explanation was clear?
 - A. Was the explanation detailed enough for you?
 - B. How would you describe the next step in your own words?
 - C. Would you like me to repeat the explanation?

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

A summary does not contain every policy term

Fictional policy-document discussion: a summary is available alongside a full policy with endorsements and exclusions; no specific loss is interpreted.

01 • Broker account executive: The client thinks this one-page summary contains every term governing their coverage.

02 • Policy service specialist: We should explain that it summarizes information, while the full policy includes additional wording and documents.

03 • Broker account executive: How would you explain an endorsement without giving a legal interpretation of this client's policy?

04 • Policy service specialist: It's a document that changes policy terms; the actual wording must be reviewed with the policy.

05 • Broker account executive: Then the absence of an exclusion from the summary doesn't prove that exclusion is absent entirely.

06 • Policy service specialist: Correct. We need the complete applicable documents before a qualified reviewer addresses a specific coverage question.

07 • Broker account executive: Can I reassure the client that the summary overrides any conflicting detail in the full documents?

08 • Policy service specialist: No. We shouldn't invent a rule of precedence or determine their legal position here.

09 • Broker account executive: I'll explain the summary's limits and help identify the full document set for review.

10 • Policy service specialist: Good. That clarifies the document distinction without promising coverage or interpreting a particular disputed term.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A certificate is not the whole contract

Separate fictional document-coordination case: a client provides a certificate as proof of detailed coverage terms, but the applicable policy wording has not been reviewed.

01 • Client insurance coordinator: The certificate lists an insurance limit. Does that tell us every condition for a future claim?

02 • Broker documentation specialist: No. A certificate isn't the complete policy wording, and the stated limit alone doesn't settle coverage.

03 • Client insurance coordinator: Could you explain the difference in plain language for our contract-management meeting today?

04 • Broker documentation specialist: One document provides selected insurance information; the policy and relevant endorsements contain the terms needing review.

05 • Client insurance coordinator: So a number on the certificate shouldn't be described as a guaranteed payment amount.

06 • Broker documentation specialist: Correct. A particular claim depends on the applicable documents and facts assessed through the proper process.

07 • Client insurance coordinator: Should we ask for the full relevant wording instead of trying to infer exclusions from the certificate?

08 • Broker documentation specialist: Yes, using the authorized document-sharing channel and an appropriately qualified reviewer for interpretation.

09 • Client insurance coordinator: I'll describe the certificate as limited information and keep the contract's insurance questions open.

10 • Broker documentation specialist: That is clearer than treating one document as a substitute for the complete coverage review.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A requested endorsement has not been issued

Separate fictional policy-service case: a broker requested a location endorsement, but no issued endorsement or confirmed effective date is available.

01 • Broker service manager: We requested the location endorsement. Can I tell the client the policy has already changed?

02 • Policy administrator: Not from the request alone. We haven't received an issued endorsement or confirmed effective date.

03 • Broker service manager: I thought endorsement request and endorsement were interchangeable because they refer to the same change.

04 • Policy administrator: The request asks for a change; an issued document records a change subject to its actual terms.

05 • Broker service manager: Then our status should distinguish requested wording from confirmed policy documentation for the client.

06 • Policy administrator: Exactly. Don't infer coverage for that location while the relevant status remains unverified.

07 • Broker service manager: Could I use the date we submitted the request as the effective date in our summary?

08 • Policy administrator: No. Submission timing doesn't establish the effective date of an approved change.

09 • Broker service manager: I'll ask for the authorized status and tell the client the endorsement remains requested.

10 • Policy administrator: Good. Once the documents arrive, the relevant wording and timing can be reviewed appropriately.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Policy Language and Coverage Interpretation

A client sees a policy summary and assumes it includes every term of coverage. The full policy has endorsements and exclusions.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are unfamiliar with one technical term in the case. Ask for a plain-English explanation and then paraphrase it. Do not pretend to understand a term you cannot explain.

Second round: Your listener is new to this field. Replace two specialist expressions with clear explanations without changing the meaning.

Model for scenario 1: The summary is an overview. The actual policy wording, including endorsements and exclusions, needs to be reviewed for the coverage question. Let's identify the relevant documents and ask the appropriate specialist to clarify them.

Scenario 2 | Two policy years in one folder

A fictional client folder contains a current-year summary and a prior-year endorsement. No current-year equivalent has been confirmed. Explain why the documents cannot simply be combined into one coverage description.

Role A: Policy documentation specialist: distinguish the periods and request the applicable current documents.

Role B: Client insurance manager: paraphrase the issue and ask what remains unknown.

Possible opening: These documents concern different policy years, so we need the applicable current set before describing coverage.

Success checks

- Identify the policy-period mismatch.
- Avoid assuming continuity of terms.
- Agree a document request and qualified review.

Add a complication: The client assumes last year's endorsement automatically applies unchanged.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 03 / READ AND NOTICE

Claims Intake and Reserving

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

SITUATION

A claim report lacks the event date and supporting documents. The intake team needs a clear follow-up request.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

claim - A request for payment or benefits under an insurance policy after a reported loss or event, subject to coverage review.

reserve - Resources set aside for a purpose; in insurance, an estimate of amounts needed for obligations.

proof of loss - Information or a formal statement supporting an insurance loss claim as required by the process.

adjuster - A person who investigates and evaluates an insurance claim.

3. Notice the language

State the action and the information needed. Explain why it matters and specify a deadline only when one is given or agreed. 'Could you' is polite; repeated apologies can obscure a legitimate request. Urgent situations may require a direct request.

Could you provide ... so that ...?

Please confirm ... by [agreed time].

If that timing is not possible, please let me know

Compare this wording: Please revert soonest with the necessary.

LESSON 03 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Ask for an actionable next step

4. Check the language

1. What does 'Please send it by Thursday' normally mean?
 - A. Keep sending it regularly until Thursday.
 - B. Send it no later than Thursday.
 - C. Send it on Thursday, but not earlier.
2. Which request gives the recipient enough detail to act?
 - A. Could you confirm the document version needed for the review?
 - B. Could you confirm that the review is important?
 - C. Could you confirm that you received my earlier message?

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Request the event date and supporting documents

Fictional claims intake: an initial report lacks an event date and supporting documents; no coverage or payment outcome is known.

01 • Claims intake specialist: Could you provide the event date and available supporting documents for this claim through our approved channel?

02 • Broker claims coordinator: The client has not confirmed the date yet. Should I estimate it from the notification email?

03 • Claims intake specialist: No. The notification date may differ from the event date; please identify the uncertainty explicitly.

04 • Broker claims coordinator: I'll ask the client for their verified account and explain which documents are currently available.

05 • Claims intake specialist: Thank you. That helps the adjuster assess the report without filling factual gaps by assumption.

06 • Broker claims coordinator: Does receiving the documents mean the insurer accepts the proof of loss and will pay?

07 • Claims intake specialist: No. Intake and review are separate from a coverage or payment decision.

08 • Broker claims coordinator: Should we tell the client any reserve amount as though it were an offered settlement?

09 • Claims intake specialist: No. A reserve isn't an offer, and case communications must follow the authorized process.

10 • Broker claims coordinator: I'll make the specific information request and confirm realistic availability without promising a claim outcome.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A document list needs a realistic response point

Separate fictional claim-coordination case: an adjuster requests an invoice and photographs; the broker has the photographs but must retrieve the invoice.

01 • Adjuster liaison: Could you provide the invoice and existing photographs so the adjuster can continue the claim review?

02 • Broker claims handler: The photographs are available, but invoice retrieval depends on the client's accounts team.

03 • Adjuster liaison: Please send the available material through the approved channel and identify the invoice as outstanding.

04 • Broker claims handler: Would you prefer that I wait until everything is available before acknowledging the request?

05 • Adjuster liaison: No. A clear partial response helps us understand progress and what still needs follow-up.

06 • Broker claims handler: I can ask accounts for an achievable retrieval time, but I can't promise delivery today.

07 • Adjuster liaison: That's appropriate. Please confirm their response rather than invent a deadline they haven't accepted.

08 • Broker claims handler: Does sending the photographs establish that the claimed amount is already accepted by the adjuster?

09 • Adjuster liaison: No. It supplies evidence for review; it doesn't determine the value or coverage outcome.

10 • Broker claims handler: I'll provide the photographs, flag the missing invoice, and return with a verified retrieval update.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Clarify whose estimate is attached

Separate fictional intake case: a repair estimate is attached without identifying its preparer or assessment date; no amount is approved.

01 • Claims administrator: Could you identify who prepared this repair estimate and when it was assessed?

02 • Broker support officer: The attachment doesn't say. The client forwarded it without the original covering message.

03 • Claims administrator: Please request the source and date so the adjuster can understand the document's basis.

04 • Broker support officer: Can we label it independent assessment because it looks like a professional estimate?

05 • Claims administrator: No. Appearance doesn't establish authorship or independence, and we shouldn't add unsupported credentials.

06 • Broker support officer: I'll seek the original document and preserve the current attachment without editing its missing details.

07 • Claims administrator: Thank you. Please also distinguish this estimate from any proof-of-loss requirements specified for the actual case.

08 • Broker support officer: Understood. Should I tell the client that the estimate sets the final reserve or payment?

09 • Claims administrator: No. Those decisions aren't established by this attachment or this request for information.

10 • Broker support officer: I'll explain the purpose of the request and confirm what the source can provide and when.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Claims Intake and Reserving

A claim report lacks the event date and supporting documents. The intake team needs a clear follow-up request.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You can help but need a clear request and its purpose. Ask what is required and whether the timing is fixed or negotiable.

Second round: The other person cannot meet the requested timing. Clarify an alternative without inventing authority to change a formal deadline.

Model for scenario 1: Could you provide the event date and the requested supporting records through the secure channel? If an item is unavailable, please tell us so the claim team can explain the next step.

Scenario 2 | Two dates need their own labels

A fictional claim form lists March 4 and March 9 without labels. The event date and reporting date are both required, but their mapping is unknown. Ask the broker to obtain a verified clarification.

Role A: Claims intake coordinator: request the meaning of each date and explain why guessing is inappropriate.

Role B: Broker claims representative: agree to ask the client and return a factual answer.

Possible opening: Could you confirm which date describes the event and which describes reporting, rather than choosing from their order?

Success checks

- Keep both date meanings unconfirmed.
- Request verification from the appropriate source.
- Avoid inferring coverage or a deadline from the unlabeled dates.

Add a complication: The broker wants to select the earlier date automatically.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 04 / READ AND NOTICE

Coverage Disputes and Denials

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

SITUATION

A client asks whether a reported loss is definitely covered. The claim review is still underway.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

denial - Decision by an insurer, payer, regulator, or authority not to approve, pay, or grant a requested item or claim.

reservation of rights - An insurer's notice preserving specified coverage positions while a matter is reviewed, subject to applicable law.

appeal - A request for a decision to be reviewed through an established process.

coverage position - An insurer's stated interpretation of how policy coverage applies to a claim.

3. Notice the language

Say what the evidence shows, identify what is still unknown, and limit the conclusion to that evidence. Words such as 'may', 'suggests', and 'in this sample' are useful when the uncertainty is real. Do not soften an urgent, verified safety concern.

The available evidence shows

This may indicate ..., but

We have not yet established whether

Compare this wording: The pilot proves this will work everywhere.

LESSON 04 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Match certainty to evidence

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence preserves uncertainty about an unconfirmed cause?
 - A. The change may have contributed to the delay.
 - B. The change must have caused the delay.
 - C. The change definitely caused the delay.
2. A result comes from a small pilot in one location. Which phrase accurately limits the claim?
 - A. In similar locations, we can now expect the same result ...
 - B. Across the service, the observed result was ...
 - C. In this pilot, the observed result was ...

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Review underway is not confirmed coverage

Fictional claims discussion: a reported loss remains under review; no coverage position has been finalized.

01 • Broker claims advocate: The client wants to know whether this loss is definitely covered before arranging their next steps.

02 • Claims liaison: The review is still underway, so we don't have a finalized coverage position to communicate.

03 • Broker claims advocate: The claim number was issued. Doesn't that indicate the insurer has accepted the claim?

04 • Claims liaison: It confirms a case record exists, not that coverage or payment has been accepted.

05 • Broker claims advocate: Then I should explain the confirmed registration and keep the coverage conclusion explicitly pending.

06 • Claims liaison: Yes. We can request a status update from the authorized claims team without predicting their decision.

07 • Broker claims advocate: Would pending mean the client should assume a denial and begin describing the matter as an appeal?

08 • Claims liaison: No. The supplied status establishes neither a denial nor the applicable next-stage process.

09 • Broker claims advocate: I'll avoid both reassurance and a negative prediction while asking what information remains under review.

10 • Claims liaison: Good. The client deserves a precise status, not certainty that the current evidence doesn't support.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A reservation letter is not necessarily a final denial

Separate fictional case: a file contains a reservation-of-rights letter, but the team's summary calls the claim denied; the full case position needs authorized review.

01 • Claims coordination manager: The summary says denied, but the document is titled reservation of rights. Are those the same status?

02 • Coverage review liaison: We shouldn't treat them as interchangeable. The actual letter and case position need qualified review.

03 • Claims coordination manager: Could the summary simply say a letter was issued while we verify its specific implications?

04 • Coverage review liaison: Yes. Identify the document accurately without assigning a final denial that hasn't been established here.

05 • Claims coordination manager: The broker asks whether an appeal deadline has started. Can we answer from the title alone?

06 • Coverage review liaison: No. Applicable processes and timing require the actual documents, facts, and authorized guidance.

07 • Claims coordination manager: I'll request clarification of the current coverage position and avoid giving an invented procedural deadline.

08 • Coverage review liaison: Good. Keep the letter's existence separate from your interpretation of what it means.

09 • Claims coordination manager: I'll correct the summary and explain that the final position isn't confirmed by our current information.

10 • Coverage review liaison: That preserves the uncertainty and directs the substantive coverage question to the appropriate reviewer.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A similar paid claim does not settle this loss

Separate fictional broker meeting: a client cites a previous paid claim, but the present loss's facts and applicable wording are still being assessed.

01 • Broker account manager: The client says a similar claim was paid last year, so this one must be covered.

02 • Claims review specialist: That history doesn't establish this case's outcome. We still need its facts and applicable policy wording.

03 • Broker account manager: Can I acknowledge the earlier payment without suggesting it guarantees the same coverage position now?

04 • Claims review specialist: Yes. Explain that the current review remains open and similarity hasn't been established in all relevant respects.

05 • Broker account manager: Would the prior payment at least prove there can be no exclusion affecting this claim?

06 • Claims review specialist: No. We cannot infer that from the payment alone or replace review of the current documents.

07 • Broker account manager: I'll ask the client for the prior reference as potentially relevant context, not decisive proof.

08 • Claims review specialist: Good. Keep any authorized comparison separate from your initial status communication to the client.

09 • Broker account manager: I'll say the earlier outcome is noted, while this loss's coverage position remains under assessment.

10 • Claims review specialist: That responds to the client's concern without promising payment or predicting a denial before review.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Coverage Disputes and Denials

A client asks whether a reported loss is definitely covered. The claim review is still underway.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

Second round: Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Model for scenario 1: The coverage review is still underway, so I cannot confirm the outcome. I can explain what information has been received, what remains outstanding, and how the team will communicate its decision.

Scenario 2 | A document request is called a denial

A fictional claimant receives a request for additional evidence and tells the broker the claim has been denied. The case record says review pending, with no final position supplied. Explain the current status and request clarification of the outstanding evidence.

Role A: Broker claims coordinator: distinguish the information request from a finalized decision.

Role B: Claims liaison: confirm the recorded pending status and offer an authorized status check.

Possible opening: The record shows a request for more evidence, not a confirmed denial in the information we have.

Success checks

- Separate an evidence request from a final coverage decision.
- Preserve the pending outcome.
- Avoid guaranteeing approval or inventing appeal advice.

Add a complication: The broker asks you to promise approval as soon as the evidence arrives.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 05 / READ AND NOTICE

Broker and Client Renewal Meetings

Compare options using the same criteria and state the tradeoff.

SITUATION

A renewal quote has a lower premium but a higher deductible. The client asks whether it is the same protection for less money.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

renewal - Continuation of a policy, contract, or subscription for a further period.

premium - The price charged for insurance coverage over a stated period.

deductible - The amount a policyholder bears before the insurer pays covered amounts as the policy specifies.

reinsurance - Insurance purchased by an insurer to transfer an agreed part of its risk.

3. Notice the language

Use the same time period, scope, and measurement basis for both options. Explain a difference with 'whereas' or 'while'. State what improves and what is given up; do not hide the weaker side of a recommendation.

Both options ..., but

Option A ..., whereas option B

The comparison depends on

Compare this wording: This option is more better.

LESSON 05 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Explain a fair comparison

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence expresses a clear contrast?
 - A. Option A is faster because option B costs less.
 - B. Option A is faster, so option B costs less.
 - C. Option A is faster, whereas option B costs less.
2. A rate increases from 6% to 7%. What is the absolute difference?
 - A. An increase of seven percentage points.
 - B. An increase of one percentage point.
 - C. An increase of one percent relative to the original rate.

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Lower premium, higher deductible

Fictional renewal comparison: A has a premium of 900 units and deductible of 200; B has a premium of 800 and deductible of 500. Other terms remain unreviewed.

01 • Client insurance manager: Quote B costs one hundred less. Is it the same protection at a lower price?

02 • Broker renewal specialist: Its deductible is five hundred rather than two hundred, and we haven't compared all other terms.

03 • Client insurance manager: So the lower premium comes with a higher stated deductible, not a verified equivalent policy.

04 • Broker renewal specialist: Correct. We should compare coverage wording, limits, exclusions, and deductible terms on the same basis.

05 • Client insurance manager: Can we calculate my exact cost for any future claim from those two numbers alone?

06 • Broker renewal specialist: No. The applicable terms and facts matter; this comparison doesn't determine a particular claim payment.

07 • Client insurance manager: Then I'll present the premium saving alongside the increased deductible instead of declaring B better.

08 • Broker renewal specialist: Good. We also need the same policy period and exposure assumptions in the comparison.

09 • Client insurance manager: I'll request the complete quotations and take the tradeoff to our authorized decision maker.

10 • Broker renewal specialist: I'll identify the verified differences and unresolved terms without recommending coverage from price alone.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A shorter quote period distorts the saving

Separate fictional renewal case: one quotation covers twelve months and another nine months; the scope and other terms have not been matched.

01 • Finance coordinator: The second renewal quote is cheaper. Can we report an annual premium saving to management?

02 • Broker placement adviser: The second quote covers nine months, while the first covers twelve. They aren't annual equivalents.

03 • Finance coordinator: Could I multiply the nine-month price to create a guaranteed twelve-month quotation for comparison?

04 • Broker placement adviser: That would be an illustration, not a supplier quote, and might ignore different terms or pricing conditions.

05 • Finance coordinator: Then we should request quotations for the same period before presenting a confirmed saving.

06 • Broker placement adviser: Yes. Use matching exposures, limits, deductibles, and relevant wording as well as time periods.

07 • Finance coordinator: The shorter term may suit our planned review date, but that's a different tradeoff from lower annual cost.

08 • Broker placement adviser: Exactly. State that scheduling preference explicitly without calling the protection or price equivalent.

09 • Finance coordinator: I'll ask for the matched information and keep the nine-month option clearly labeled in the renewal pack.

10 • Broker placement adviser: Good. That lets the decision maker compare real differences rather than a misleading headline discount.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

An additional service is not automatically broader coverage

Separate fictional renewal comparison: quote A includes a risk-review visit; quote B does not. Policy wording and the visit's scope remain unreviewed.

01 • Client risk coordinator: Quote A includes a risk-review visit. Does that mean its insurance coverage is broader than B's?

02 • Broker relationship manager: Not necessarily. A service feature and the policy's coverage terms are different comparison categories.

03 • Client risk coordinator: Then we should compare the visit separately from limits, exclusions, premium, and deductible details.

04 • Broker relationship manager: Yes. We also need the visit's actual scope before describing its value to your team.

05 • Client risk coordinator: Someone mentioned reinsurance support in the marketing material. Does that guarantee a better claim outcome?

06 • Broker relationship manager: We shouldn't make that inference. Marketing references don't replace the applicable policy and claims review.

07 • Client risk coordinator: I'll list the included service as a verified feature, with its scope still awaiting clarification.

08 • Broker relationship manager: Good. Ask for comparable policy documents before treating either option as more comprehensive protection.

09 • Client risk coordinator: Our decision discussion will separate service convenience from the financial and coverage terms needing review.

10 • Broker relationship manager: That gives the client a fair renewal comparison without an unsupported recommendation based on one feature.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Broker and Client Renewal Meetings

A renewal quote has a lower premium but a higher deductible. The client asks whether it is the same protection for less money.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You favor one option but have not checked whether the scope is comparable. Ask about one difference, then explain the tradeoff you are willing to accept.

Second round: Your listener focuses only on the lowest price or fastest date. Explain one other relevant comparison criterion.

Model for scenario 1: The premium is lower, but the deductible has changed. We should compare the coverage terms and other differences as well before describing the options as equivalent.

Scenario 2 | Two quotes use different insured values

Two fictional renewal quotations show different premiums, but one uses an insured value of 100,000 units and the other 80,000. Deductibles and detailed terms remain unreviewed. Discuss the mismatched basis and request a comparable quotation.

Role A: Broker renewal analyst: explain why the lower premium isn't yet an equivalent-price comparison.

Role B: Client finance manager: ask for matching assumptions and identify who will review the terms.

Possible opening: These quotes use different insured values, so the premium difference isn't a like-for-like saving yet.

Success checks

- Identify the differing insured values.
- Avoid recommending unsupported or inaccurate values.
- Request matched assumptions and qualified review.

Add a complication: The manager wants to use the lower value solely to obtain the cheaper quote.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 06 / READ AND NOTICE

Fraud Indicators and SIU Referral

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

SITUATION

An unusual claim pattern prompts concern. A note calls the customer fraudulent before an investigation has established the facts.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

fraud indicator - An observation that may warrant investigation but does not by itself prove fraud.

SIU - Special investigation unit: an insurance team examining claims or concerns that need specialist investigation.

material misrepresentation - A false or misleading statement significant to a decision under applicable law or contract terms.

investigation - A systematic effort to establish facts and understand an event or concern.

3. Notice the language

Say what the evidence shows, identify what is still unknown, and limit the conclusion to that evidence. Words such as 'may', 'suggests', and 'in this sample' are useful when the uncertainty is real. Do not soften an urgent, verified safety concern.

The available evidence shows

This may indicate ..., but

We have not yet established whether

Compare this wording: The pilot proves this will work everywhere.

LESSON 06 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Match certainty to evidence

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence preserves uncertainty about an unconfirmed cause?
 - A. The change definitely caused the delay.
 - B. The change may have contributed to the delay.
 - C. The change must have caused the delay.
2. A result comes from a small pilot in one location. Which phrase accurately limits the claim?
 - A. In this pilot, the observed result was ...
 - B. In similar locations, we can now expect the same result ...
 - C. Across the service, the observed result was ...

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

An unusual pattern is not established fraud

Fictional internal referral: a claim pattern is unusual, but investigation has not established fraud; sensitive details remain in the approved internal channel.

01 • Claims analyst: The referral draft calls the customer fraudulent because the claim pattern looks unusual.

02 • Investigation supervisor: That conclusion isn't established. Describe the observed pattern as a potential fraud indicator for review.

03 • Claims analyst: Should I explain which records prompted the concern rather than label the customer's character?

04 • Investigation supervisor: Yes. Keep facts, discrepancies, and interpretations distinct when referring to the special investigation unit, or SIU.

05 • Claims analyst: Does referral mean the SIU has already confirmed material misrepresentation in the submission?

06 • Investigation supervisor: No. Referral requests assessment; it doesn't establish intent, misrepresentation, or an investigation outcome.

07 • Claims analyst: I'll remove the accusation and preserve the original supporting records through the approved restricted process.

08 • Investigation supervisor: Good. Don't share sensitive case details in general team discussions or contact the customer outside authorization.

09 • Claims analyst: The revised note will identify the concern and unanswered questions without asserting guilt.

10 • Investigation supervisor: That supports a fair investigation while keeping the language proportionate to the evidence actually available.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Two matching amounts need context

Separate fictional internal review: two claims contain identical estimate amounts; preparers and underlying circumstances have not been compared.

01 • Claims review officer: These two estimates have identical amounts. Is that enough to say the documents were fabricated?

02 • SIU liaison: No. Matching amounts are an observation; fabrication is a conclusion requiring additional evidence and investigation.

03 • Claims review officer: We haven't compared the preparers or underlying circumstances, so several explanations remain open.

04 • SIU liaison: Exactly. Record the similarity accurately and identify the context that hasn't been established.

05 • Claims review officer: Should I describe the match as a possible fraud indicator in the authorized referral?

06 • SIU liaison: You can identify the concern neutrally, following the internal referral process rather than making an accusation.

07 • Claims review officer: Could we alter the case label to confirmed fraud so it receives a faster review?

08 • SIU liaison: No. Urgency doesn't justify a false status or prejudging the people involved.

09 • Claims review officer: I'll preserve the estimates and request review of the matching amounts with their source details.

10 • SIU liaison: Good. A precise observation gives investigators something to assess without substituting suspicion for a finding.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A corrected answer does not establish intent

Separate fictional submission review: a customer corrects an earlier answer about an event; the reason for the difference has not been established.

01 • Claims coordinator: The customer changed an answer. Can the referral say they intentionally misrepresented the event?

02 • Investigation reviewer: The changed answer is documented, but intention hasn't been established from that difference alone.

03 • Claims coordinator: Then I should preserve both versions and state exactly what changed without choosing a motive.

04 • Investigation reviewer: Yes. The authorized investigation can examine the context and any relevant supporting evidence.

05 • Claims coordinator: Would calling it material misrepresentation merely summarize the discrepancy in more professional language?

06 • Investigation reviewer: No. That term carries a substantive conclusion we shouldn't assert without the appropriate basis and review.

07 • Claims coordinator: I'll use a neutral description and identify the unanswered question about why the answer changed.

08 • Investigation reviewer: Good. Keep the referral and any customer contact within the approved process for this case.

09 • Claims coordinator: I'll avoid promising either an adverse finding or exoneration while the facts are still assessed.

10 • Investigation reviewer: That preserves fairness and gives the reviewer a reliable account of what the evidence actually shows.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Fraud Indicators and SIU Referral

An unusual claim pattern prompts concern. A note calls the customer fraudulent before an investigation has established the facts.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

Second round: Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Model for scenario 1: The pattern is an indicator for review, not proof of fraud. I'll describe the observed facts neutrally and route the concern through the appropriate investigation process.

Scenario 2 | A shared address prompts an unsupported accusation

Two fictional claims list the same business mailing address. The relationship between the claimants is unverified. An internal draft calls this coordinated fraud. Discuss a neutral referral without seeking sensitive details outside authorized channels.

Role A: Claims analyst: describe the shared address and unknown relationship.

Role B: Investigation liaison: challenge the conclusion and request an evidence-based internal summary.

Possible opening: The records share a mailing address, but that alone doesn't establish coordinated fraud.

Success checks

- Separate the shared address from an unproven allegation.
- Keep evidence and referral within authorized channels.
- Identify the relationship as unknown rather than inventing it.

Add a complication: A colleague suggests contacting unrelated people publicly to investigate the address.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 07 / READ AND NOTICE

Actuarial Assumptions and Pricing

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

SITUATION

An actuarial update shows claim costs rising because both the number of claims and average cost per claim increased.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

loss development - Changes in estimated or reported insurance losses as more information becomes available over time.

frequency - How often an event occurs within a stated population or period.

severity - The seriousness of an event, impact, or loss under stated criteria.

reserve adequacy - Whether estimated insurance reserves are sufficient for the obligations they are intended to cover.

3. Notice the language

Start with the reader's question. Explain one unfamiliar term with familiar words, then give a relevant example or contrast. Check understanding without asking only 'Do you understand?'.

In this context, ... means

The difference is that

How would you explain that distinction to a colleague?

Compare this wording: We need to operationalize the implementation.

LESSON 07 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Make a complex point clear

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence explains 'backlog' rather than repeating it?
 - A. The backlog is the work still waiting to be completed.
 - B. The backlog is the work completed during the last period.
 - C. The backlog is the maximum work the team can finish in a period.
2. Which follow-up best checks whether your explanation was clear?
 - A. Would you like me to repeat the explanation?
 - B. Was the explanation detailed enough for you?
 - C. How would you describe the next step in your own words?

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

More claims and costlier claims

Fictional actuarial explanation: comparable exposure periods show both increased claim frequency and increased average claim severity; no pricing decision is supplied.

01 • Portfolio manager: Claim costs increased. Can you explain how both frequency and severity contributed in this report?

02 • Actuarial analyst: Frequency concerns how often claims occur relative to the exposure basis; severity concerns average cost per claim.

03 • Portfolio manager: So more claims and more expensive claims are different drivers, even when total costs rise together.

04 • Actuarial analyst: Exactly. The report says both increased on its comparable basis, rather than attributing everything to one driver.

05 • Portfolio manager: Does higher severity mean every individual claim became more expensive than every claim last year?

06 • Actuarial analyst: No. An average doesn't describe each claim, and the mix can affect that summary.

07 • Portfolio manager: I'll explain the two drivers separately and include the comparison period and exposure basis.

08 • Actuarial analyst: Good. Keep any pricing recommendation separate from this descriptive explanation of the observed claim experience.

09 • Portfolio manager: Should reserve adequacy be declared from those two increases alone during the meeting?

10 • Actuarial analyst: No. Reserve assessment requires its own analysis and assumptions, including relevant loss-development information.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Paid so far is not the final claim cost

Separate fictional actuarial briefing: a recent claim cohort has paid amounts recorded, but some claims remain open and development assumptions need review.

01 • Finance reporting manager: The paid total is available. Why doesn't the actuarial report call it the final cost?

02 • Reserving analyst: Some claims remain open, so amounts paid so far don't establish their eventual total cost.

03 • Finance reporting manager: Is loss development the way reported claim costs change as more information becomes available?

04 • Reserving analyst: Yes, broadly. The specific analysis and assumptions need to be explained for this cohort.

05 • Finance reporting manager: Then a current payment total is an observation, while an ultimate-cost estimate includes assessed future development.

06 • Reserving analyst: Correct. We should label those figures separately instead of presenting an estimate as settled fact.

07 • Finance reporting manager: Could the lower paid total for recent claims prove their severity is lower than older claims?

08 • Reserving analyst: Not without accounting for maturity and comparable definitions. Recent claims have had less time to develop.

09 • Finance reporting manager: I'll request the matched comparison and preserve the estimate's assumptions in the briefing.

10 • Reserving analyst: Good. That clarifies why paid amounts alone don't determine final cost or reserve adequacy.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Claim counts need an exposure denominator

Separate fictional portfolio comparison: A records 20 claims across 1,000 policy-years; B records 30 across 3,000 policy-years, with comparable definitions assumed for this exercise.

01 • Pricing trainee: Portfolio B has thirty claims and A has twenty. Is B's frequency higher?

02 • Actuarial tutor: Not on this exposure basis. A has one thousand policy-years; B has three thousand.

03 • Pricing trainee: So we compare claims per policy-year, rather than only the raw number of claims.

04 • Actuarial tutor: Exactly. These figures give twenty per thousand for A and ten per thousand for B.

05 • Pricing trainee: B has more claims in total but a lower frequency relative to the supplied exposure.

06 • Actuarial tutor: Correct. That distinction matters whenever portfolio sizes differ in an actuarial comparison.

07 • Pricing trainee: Does the lower frequency also establish lower severity or a lower appropriate premium for B?

08 • Actuarial tutor: No. We haven't supplied claim amounts or the other information needed for pricing analysis.

09 • Pricing trainee: I'll state the frequency result only, using the same denominator and clearly defined period.

10 • Actuarial tutor: Good. Keep frequency, severity, and any reserve or pricing conclusions distinct instead of extending one calculation.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Actuarial Assumptions and Pricing

An actuarial update shows claim costs rising because both the number of claims and average cost per claim increased.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are unfamiliar with one technical term in the case. Ask for a plain-English explanation and then paraphrase it. Do not pretend to understand a term you cannot explain.

Second round: Your listener is new to this field. Replace two specialist expressions with clear explanations without changing the meaning.

Model for scenario 1: Both frequency and severity contributed to the increase. I'll show the number of claims separately from their average cost so the audience can understand the two drivers.

Scenario 2 | An average is changed by one large claim

A fictional portfolio's average claim cost increased, and one unusually large claim is present. The analyst has not assessed how much it explains or whether frequency changed. Explain the difference between severity and a portfolio-wide claim trend.

Role A: Actuarial analyst: explain the average and the unassessed influence of the large claim.

Role B: Portfolio manager: ask which comparison would clarify the driver without discarding valid data.

Possible opening: Average severity rose, but we haven't measured how much the large claim explains or whether frequency changed.

Success checks

- Distinguish average severity from frequency.
- Preserve the claim in the evidence.
- Request transparent analysis rather than claim an established cause.

Add a complication: The manager suggests deleting the large claim solely to make the trend look better.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 08 / READ AND NOTICE

Compliance, Market Conduct, and Complaints

Acknowledge a communication problem and give a corrected message.

SITUATION

A policyholder's complaint received a generic reply that did not address a specific fee question.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

market conduct - How an insurer or financial firm treats customers and carries out market-facing activities.

complaint - An expression of dissatisfaction requiring attention under a relevant process.

timely communication - Providing information early enough to meet the relevant need or required process.

corrective action - Action taken to fix a current problem and prevent recurrence.

3. Notice the language

Name what was unclear or wrong, acknowledge its effect, and correct it. A brief apology can help, followed by a practical next step. Avoid explaining away the other person's reaction or promising an outcome you cannot control.

My earlier message did not make ... clear.

I'm sorry for The correct information is

Let me check that the revised explanation addresses

Compare this wording: I'm sorry if you failed to understand.

LESSON 08 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Repair a misunderstanding

4. Check the language

1. Which apology takes responsibility for unclear wording?
 - A. I'm sorry the process took longer than expected.
 - B. I'm sorry we could not meet the original date.
 - C. I'm sorry my earlier wording was unclear.
2. What should follow an apology for an incorrect date?
 - A. A new guaranteed date even if it is unverified.
 - B. The corrected date and the current confirmation status.
 - C. A longer explanation that never states the correct date.

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

The generic reply missed the fee question

Fictional complaint review: a policyholder asked about a fee and received a generic response; the fee's case-specific basis has not been checked.

01 • Broker complaints liaison: The policyholder asked why a fee was charged, but the response only thanked them for contacting us.

02 • Complaints supervisor: You're right. Our reply didn't address the specific question, and we need to acknowledge that omission.

03 • Broker complaints liaison: Can you now confirm the charge was wrong so the policyholder receives a definite answer?

04 • Complaints supervisor: Not before reviewing the relevant records. Correcting our communication doesn't establish the fee's validity.

05 • Broker complaints liaison: Then the apology should explain what was missing and identify the next case-specific check.

06 • Complaints supervisor: Yes. I'll say we failed to answer the fee question and are seeking its documented basis.

07 • Broker complaints liaison: Please avoid repeating a general fee description as though it settles this particular transaction.

08 • Complaints supervisor: Agreed. Timely communication should give an accurate review status, not an unsupported conclusion.

09 • Broker complaints liaison: I'll relay that correction and ask who will provide the authorized explanation to the policyholder.

10 • Complaints supervisor: I'll own the follow-up and record the communication corrective action separately from the unresolved fee assessment.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A complaint was acknowledged, not resolved

Separate fictional case: an automated message calls a complaint resolved when the record shows acknowledgment only; substantive review remains open.

01 • Client service coordinator: The automated message says resolved, but the complaint record shows only acknowledgment so far.

02 • Market conduct reviewer: We need to correct that status. Acknowledging receipt is not resolution of the policyholder's concern.

03 • Client service coordinator: What should I say about the misleading message without blaming the policyholder for believing it?

04 • Market conduct reviewer: Say our message overstated progress, apologize, and explain that the substantive review remains open.

05 • Client service coordinator: Should I promise the complaint will be resolved tomorrow to repair the disappointment?

06 • Market conduct reviewer: No timing is confirmed. Ask the responsible team for an achievable update rather than invent a deadline.

07 • Client service coordinator: I'm sorry our message called your complaint resolved. We have acknowledged it, but the substantive review remains open.

08 • Market conduct reviewer: Good. The automated wording also needs a separate corrective-action review to prevent repeated confusion.

09 • Client service coordinator: I'll keep that communication fix distinct from deciding whether the policyholder's complaint is upheld.

10 • Market conduct reviewer: Exactly. Both issues matter, but correcting a status message doesn't determine the underlying case outcome.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A promised callback was not an agreed decision date

Separate fictional complaints case: an agent promised a decision during Friday's callback, although only a status update had been arranged with the review team.

01 • Broker service liaison: You promised a complaint decision on Friday, but the review team only agreed a status update.

02 • Complaints case manager: I'm sorry. I described the callback too strongly and created an expectation they hadn't authorized.

03 • Broker service liaison: The client has arranged time to discuss the outcome. How will you correct that expectation?

04 • Complaints case manager: I'll explain that Friday's call remains a status update, with no final decision date confirmed.

05 • Broker service liaison: Could you say the result is likely favorable to make the correction less disappointing?

06 • Complaints case manager: No. We don't have evidence for that prediction, and it would create another unsupported expectation.

07 • Broker service liaison: Please acknowledge the inconvenience directly and explain what information the scheduled call can provide.

08 • Complaints case manager: I'll cover verified progress, open questions, and the responsible review contact, without promising an outcome.

09 • Broker service liaison: I'll ensure our own client note uses that corrected description of the callback.

10 • Complaints case manager: Thank you. I'll record the wording correction as part of our complaint-handling follow-up.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Compliance, Market Conduct, and Complaints

A policyholder's complaint received a generic reply that did not address a specific fee question.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are frustrated because an earlier message created an expectation. Explain that expectation. Ask your partner to distinguish the correction from anything still uncertain.

Second round: The listener remains disappointed after the correction. Acknowledge the impact and restate the available next step calmly.

Model for scenario 1: Our earlier reply did not answer your fee question. I'm sorry. I'll record that point for review and explain the next step and expected update under our complaints process.

Scenario 2 | The reply names the wrong complaint

A fictional policyholder complained about a delayed document, but the reply discusses a payment dispute. Neither issue has been reviewed in this case. Correct the mismatch and agree a check of the actual document request.

Role A: Complaints supervisor: acknowledge that the response addressed the wrong subject.

Role B: Broker service coordinator: explain the policyholder's actual concern and ask who will check the document status.

Possible opening: Our reply addressed a payment dispute, but your client's complaint concerns a delayed document.

Success checks

- Correct the subject without blaming the policyholder.
- Keep document delivery timing unconfirmed.
- Assign the document-status follow-up.

Add a complication: The coordinator asks for a guaranteed delivery date before the document team responds.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

Answer workshop

Try the tasks first. The model is one acceptable response to scenario 1, not a script to memorize. Assess your spoken version using the four criteria at the end.

01 | Underwriting and Risk Selection

Editing example: Could you explain what this means?

After an introductory phrase such as 'Could you explain', the embedded question uses statement word order: "what this means".

Check 1: A - Could you confirm when the review starts?

A: The embedded question uses subject then verb: "the review starts".

B: Remove 'does' and use statement word order after 'confirm'.

C: Place the subject 'the review' before 'starts'.

Check 2: C - Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review?

A: This asks about delivery timing, not whether approval has happened.

B: This asks about the presenter, not the report's approval status.

C: This question distinguishes two meanings of 'ready' that affect the next action.

Model response: Could you confirm the activities, locations, and requested loss-history information? Those details will help the underwriting team assess the submission without relying on assumptions about the business.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

02 | Policy Language and Coverage Interpretation

Editing example: We need to put the plan into practice.

The revised sentence names the action in familiar words. Specialist vocabulary is useful when it adds precision, but repeating abstract nouns can hide the meaning.

Check 1: C - The backlog is the work still waiting to be completed.

A: Completed work is different from work still waiting.

B: This describes capacity, not the work waiting to be completed.

C: This gives the meaning in familiar words.

Check 2: B - How would you describe the next step in your own words?

A: This invites an opinion on detail, not a demonstration of understanding.

B: An open request lets the listener show their understanding.

C: Offering repetition may help, but it does not show how the listener understood the next step.

Model response: The summary is an overview. The actual policy wording, including endorsements and exclusions, needs to be reviewed for the coverage question. Let's identify the relevant documents and ask the appropriate specialist to clarify them.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

03 | Claims Intake and Reserving

Editing example: Could you send the missing document and confirm when it will be available?

The revision names the document and requested response. It avoids expressions that may be unfamiliar or ambiguous for an international audience.

Check 1: B - Send it no later than Thursday.

A: This interprets a deadline as a continuing activity, which would use "until".

B: 'By' sets the latest point, while 'after' refers to a later time.

C: "By Thursday" permits earlier delivery; it is not restricted to that day.

Check 2: A - Could you confirm the document version needed for the review?

A: The requested action and information are explicit.

B: This checks importance rather than identifying the needed document version.

C: This checks receipt, not which version is required for the review.

Model response: Could you provide the event date and the requested supporting records through the secure channel? If an item is unavailable, please tell us so the claim team can explain the next step.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

04 | Coverage Disputes and Denials

Editing example: The pilot worked in the tested setting; performance elsewhere remains untested.

The revision states the finding and its scope. It avoids turning limited evidence into a universal claim.

Check 1: A - The change may have contributed to the delay.

A: 'May have contributed' presents a possibility without claiming the cause is established.

B: 'Must have' expresses a strong inference that the evidence may not support.

C: 'Definitely' presents the cause as certain.

Check 2: C - In this pilot, the observed result was ...

A: Similarity alone does not establish that the result will transfer.

B: A pilot in one location does not establish a service-wide observation.

C: This locates the finding in the setting actually studied.

Model response: The coverage review is still underway, so I cannot confirm the outcome. I can explain what information has been received, what remains outstanding, and how the team will communicate its decision.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

05 | Broker and Client Renewal Meetings

Editing example: This option is better on cost, but slower to deliver.

'Better' already has comparative meaning, so it does not need 'more'. Naming the criterion and tradeoff makes the comparison useful.

Check 1: C - Option A is faster, whereas option B costs less.

A: 'Because' claims a causal connection that is not given.

B: 'So' implies one fact causes the other.

C: 'Whereas' marks a contrast between two options.

Check 2: B - An increase of one percentage point.

A: The new rate is 7%; the difference between the rates is one percentage point.

B: Subtracting 6% from 7% gives one percentage point. The relative increase is about 16.7%.

C: A one-percent relative increase on 6% would be 6.06%, not 7%.

Model response: The premium is lower, but the deductible has changed. We should compare the coverage terms and other differences as well before describing the options as equivalent.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

06 | Fraud Indicators and SIU Referral

Editing example: The pilot worked in the tested setting; performance elsewhere remains untested.

The revision states the finding and its scope. It avoids turning limited evidence into a universal claim.

Check 1: B - The change may have contributed to the delay.

A: 'Definitely' presents the cause as certain.

B: 'May have contributed' presents a possibility without claiming the cause is established.

C: 'Must have' expresses a strong inference that the evidence may not support.

Check 2: A - In this pilot, the observed result was ...

A: This locates the finding in the setting actually studied.

B: Similarity alone does not establish that the result will transfer.

C: A pilot in one location does not establish a service-wide observation.

Model response: The pattern is an indicator for review, not proof of fraud. I'll describe the observed facts neutrally and route the concern through the appropriate investigation process.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

07 | Actuarial Assumptions and Pricing

Editing example: We need to put the plan into practice.

The revised sentence names the action in familiar words. Specialist vocabulary is useful when it adds precision, but repeating abstract nouns can hide the meaning.

Check 1: A - The backlog is the work still waiting to be completed.

A: This gives the meaning in familiar words.

B: Completed work is different from work still waiting.

C: This describes capacity, not the work waiting to be completed.

Check 2: C - How would you describe the next step in your own words?

A: Offering repetition may help, but it does not show how the listener understood the next step.

B: This invites an opinion on detail, not a demonstration of understanding.

C: An open request lets the listener show their understanding.

Model response: Both frequency and severity contributed to the increase. I'll show the number of claims separately from their average cost so the audience can understand the two drivers.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

08 | Compliance, Market Conduct, and Complaints

Editing example: I'm sorry my message did not explain the timing clearly.

The revision takes responsibility for the message without blaming the listener. It identifies what needs to be corrected.

Check 1: C - I'm sorry my earlier wording was unclear.

A: This acknowledges duration, but does not take responsibility for the unclear wording.

B: This acknowledges a missed date, not the communication problem in the question.

C: This acknowledges the speaker's contribution to the problem.

Check 2: B - The corrected date and the current confirmation status.

A: An unsupported new promise can create a second misunderstanding.

B: A repair needs usable corrected information, including any uncertainty.

C: The reader still lacks the information they need.

Model response: Our earlier reply did not answer your fee question. I'm sorry. I'll record that point for review and explain the next step and expected update under our complaints process.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and writes a 70-110 word message. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

Fictional language practice. Legal, financial, and regulatory meanings depend on jurisdiction and context; use current documents and qualified review for actual decisions.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.

Extend your practice with AI

Use the following prompts after your own first attempt. Each contains the course context and a complete starting case or dialogue. Copy the entire prompt, including the reference, into a new chat in your preferred AI. You can also use the links to copy it from the website.

Choose the right kind of help

A role-play prompt makes the AI wait for your replies. A new-dialogue prompt asks for a complete professional script. Vocabulary and grammar prompts move from explanation to your own attempts.

Choose any lesson or dialogue online

The course prompt workshop has four practice goals and B1 support, B2 independent and C1 stretch settings. These are practice choices, not assessed proficiency levels. Select the same lesson number or dialogue title you used in this guide.

[Open this course's AI prompt workshop](#)

Keep practice useful

Use fictional or anonymized details. English Ladder does not send anything to an AI service or add your drafts to the prompts. Your chosen service's terms and any usage charges apply. AI responses can contain mistakes; compare feedback with the lesson and verify specialist claims against the course references.

Each starter prompt uses B2 practice. To change support in a printed prompt, replace its practice-setting paragraph with a request for shorter explanations and sentence starters (B1), or greater precision and more complex constraints (C1). Keep the professional facts unchanged.

Changing the example

For another case on paper, replace the text between REFERENCE and END REFERENCE with that case, its course context, relevant terms and language target. Include the full exchange if practicing a dialogue. Do not assume your AI can access this PDF or a link. The website makes this substitution for you.

Prompt edition: 2026-09-30. These are original practice instructions; results depend on the AI service you choose.

Practice grammar in context

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Insurance English

Professional audience: underwriters, claims adjusters, brokers, risk managers, actuarial analysts, policy-service teams, compliance staff, and insurance operations leaders

Scope: Fictional language practice. Legal, financial, and regulatory meanings depend on jurisdiction and context; use current documents and qualified review for actual decisions.

Lesson 01: Underwriting and Risk Selection

Original fictional case: An underwriting submission describes a business activity broadly but omits its operating locations and loss history.

Language workshop: Ask a precise question

Communication goal: Clarify missing information before responding.

Language guidance: Name the exact word, fact, or requirement you need clarified. Ask one focused question at a time. Repeat your understanding and give the other person a chance to correct it.

Useful frames (complete the gaps with case facts): When you say ..., do you mean ...? / Could you clarify which ...? / So, my understanding is Is that right?

Vocabulary: underwriting: Evaluation of risk and terms used to decide whether and on what conditions to issue insurance, extend credit, or accept an investment exposure. / risk appetite: The amount and types of risk an organization is prepared to pursue or retain. / exposure: The extent to which people, assets, or operations are subject to a hazard or potential loss. / loss history: A record of prior claims or losses for an insured risk.

Speaking task: Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

Writing task: Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

Optional second-round challenge: The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Model for comparison AFTER my attempt, not a response to give me first: Could you confirm the activities, locations, and requested loss-history information? Those details will help the underwriting team assess the submission without relying on assumptions about the business.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Grammar that changes the meaning

1. For a lesson, use its language workshop as the focus. For a dialogue, quote one actual sentence and select one useful grammar feature from it, such as question word order, tense, modality, conditionals or clause linking. Explain in no more than 90 words how this feature helps the speakers do their work. Keep the grammar target narrow.
2. Give two short contrasting sentences using this workplace context. Explain the difference in time, certainty, condition or politeness. Label invented examples and preserve the distinction between possible, planned and confirmed events. Describe context-dependent choices as choices, not universal rules.
3. Give me one editing or sentence-building task using a known case fact. Do not copy the supplied editing example or reveal its answer. Ask me to explain my intended meaning. Stop and wait.
4. After I answer, quote my wording, identify at most two issues, and give a brief explanation and one hint. Ask me to revise before offering a full corrected version. Then accept any accurate, natural alternative that serves the purpose.
5. Continue with two new tasks, one at a time: first guided, then an original response without a sentence frame. End with a two-sentence workplace message using the target feature and a compact self-check. Do not replace this sequence with a worksheet and answer key.

END PROMPT

Copy this prompt online or choose another lesson and support level